

Time Expressions for Verb Tenses

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Time expressions signal which tense to use. The main groups are:

- 1 Finished time → past simple — yesterday, last week, in 2019, ago.
- 2 Unfinished / experience → present perfect — ever, never, just, already, yet, since, for.
- 3 Now / temporary → present continuous — now, at the moment, today.

Match the marker to the tense: 'yesterday' forces the past simple; 'since/for' pull the present perfect; 'now' pulls the present continuous.

At a glance

Tense	Typical time expressions	Example
Present simple	always, usually, often, every day, on Mondays	I usually walk to work.
Present continuous	now, right now, at the moment, today, this week	I'm working from home today .
Present perfect	ever, never, just, already, yet, so far, since, for, recently	I've just finished.
Past simple	yesterday, last week, in 2019, ago, when, then	I saw her yesterday .
Past continuous	while, as, when (+ background), at 8pm yesterday	I was cooking at eight .
Future (will / going to)	tomorrow, next week, soon, later, in the future	I'll call you later .

Learning objectives

- Can match common time expressions to the correct tense (CEFR B1).
- Can use signal words to justify a tense choice.
- Can correct tense errors caused by mismatched time markers.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Time Expressions for Verb Tenses · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. Which time expression goes with the past simple? 'I saw her ____.'

- A. since Monday
- B. yesterday
- C. just
- D. already

2. ____, I'm studying for an exam.

- A. Every day
- B. At the moment
- C. In 2019
- D. Yesterday

3. She's ____ finished her homework.

- A. yesterday
- B. just
- C. last week
- D. two days ago

4. I ____ him yesterday.

- A. have seen
- B. saw
- C. see
- D. am seeing

5. We've lived here ____ 2020.

- A. in
- B. since
- C. at
- D. by

6. I ____ to the gym on Mondays.

- A. am going
- B. go
- C. have gone
- D. went

7. Have you finished ____?

- A. yesterday
- B. yet
- C. now
- D. then

8. Look — it ____ right now.

- A. rains
- B. is raining
- C. rained
- D. has rained

9. Which time word forces the past simple?

- A. ever
- B. since
- C. in 2019
- D. yet

10. I'll call you ____.

- A. yesterday
- B. later
- C. already
- D. since Monday

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. yesterday** — 'Yesterday' is finished time, which takes the past simple.
2. **B. At the moment** — 'At the moment' signals a temporary situation now, matching the present continuous.
3. **B. just** — 'Just' goes with the present perfect: 'She's just finished'.
4. **B. saw** — A finished-time word like 'yesterday' takes the past simple: 'saw'.
5. **B. since** — 'Since' + a starting point goes with the present perfect: 'since 2020'.
6. **B. go** — A regular habit ('on Mondays') takes the present simple: 'go'.
7. **B. yet** — 'Yet' goes with the present perfect in questions and negatives: 'Have you finished yet?'.
8. **B. is raining** — 'Right now' takes the present continuous: 'is raining'.
9. **C. in 2019** — 'In 2019' is finished time, which forces the past simple.
10. **B. later** — 'Later' points to the future, matching 'will call'.